SORT THE SCHWA: E, O, I, U

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Sixteen words, four for each letter. Say each word out loud and listen for the syllable you do not stress. Which vowel letter is spelling the lazy "uh" sound? Write the word in that column. Four words go in each column.

SIXTEEN WORDS

April **chicken** **cactus** **ribbon** **problem** **fossil**
lesson **pencil** **walrus** **garden** **pupil** **album** **wagon** **open**
circus **button**

e ə as in problem	o ə as in lesson	i ə as in pencil	u ə as in circus

Why this matters: all sixteen unstressed syllables sound the same when you say them, so your ear cannot tell you which letter to write. That is the whole problem with the schwa, and it is why these words have to be looked at as well as listened to.

Extra: every one of these sixteen words is stressed on the *first* syllable, so the schwa is always in the second. Underline the first syllable in each word you wrote, then read the word list again putting the stress on the wrong syllable. The schwa moves, and the word stops sounding like a word.

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SORT THE SCHWA: E, O, I, U ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Sixteen words, four for each letter. Say each word out loud and listen for the syllable you do not stress. Which vowel letter is spelling the lazy "uh" sound? Write the word in that column. Four words go in each column.

SIXTEEN WORDS: **April** · **chicken** · **cactus** · **ribbon** · **problem** · **fossil** · **lesson** · **pencil** · **walrus** · **garden** · **pupil** · **album** · **wagon** · **open** · **circus** · **button**

e ə as in problem	o ə as in lesson	i ə as in pencil	u ə as in circus
problem	lesson	pencil	circus
garden	wagon	pupil	album
chicken	ribbon	April	cactus
open	button	fossil	walrus

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